

ch-3 — Free APIs & Resources

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- Free public API directories
- Free domain (for deploying / demos)
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- Wire it into your project
- Quick test (before you code)

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Picking a **Data / scraper / report, bot, or web app** idea for your ch-3 project? Start from a free, no-credit-card API so you can build fast. See also: [ch3-ideas-toolkit.md](#) · [GITHUB_SEARCH.md](#)

Free public API directories

Browse these to find an API that fits your idea (weather, movies, crypto, jokes, maps...):

Directory	Notes
https://publicapis.dev/	Clean searchable index, filter by category
https://www.freepublicapis.com/	Curated, shows auth + HTTPS at a glance
https://free-apis.github.io/#/categories	Grouped by category
https://github.com/public-api-lists/public-api-lists	Big GitHub list (good for gh search)

Free domain (for deploying / demos)

Resource	Notes
https://github.com/DigitalPlatDev/FreeDomain	Free subdomains for student projects

How to pick (ch-3 fit)

1. **No key / no card first.** Many APIs work with zero signup — fastest to demo.
2. **Read the auth column.** If a key is needed, keep it in `.env` (never commit it).
3. **HTTPS only.** Skip http-only APIs.
4. **Small response.** Pick an endpoint that returns clean JSON you can parse.

Wire it into your project

- **MCP:** use the `fetch` MCP so Claude can call the API live; `filesystem` to save results.
- **Skill:** `data-validate` — schema + sanity checks on the API response.

- **Agent:** `data-cleaner` — normalize / dedupe the rows before you report.

```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "fetch": { "command": "npx", "args": ["-y", "@modelcontextprotocol/server-
fetch"] }
  }
}
```

Secrets: API keys go in `.env` + `.gitignore`. Never hard-code a key in your repo — the ch-3 checker (and real life) will catch it.

Quick test (before you code)

```
curl -s "https://api.example.com/v1/endpoint" | head
```

JSON back → good, build on it. Error / HTML → pick another.